

029. Chapter 3 Verses 7-8

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.7

यस्त्विन्द्रियाणि मनसा नियम्यारभतेऽर्जुन ।
कर्मेन्द्रियैः कर्मयोगमसक्तः स विशिष्यते ॥ ७ ॥

yastvindriyāṇi manasā
niyamyārabhate'rjuna |
karmendriyaiḥ karmayogam
asaktaḥ sa viśiṣyate ||

yaḥ – who; tu – but; indriyāṇi – the senses; manasā – by the mind; niyamyā – controlling; ārabhate – begins/engages in; arjuna – O Arjuna; karma-indriyaiḥ – by the organs of action; karma-yogam – Karma Yoga; asaktaḥ – unattached; saḥ – he; viśiṣyate – is superior.

But, O Arjuna! he who controls the senses with the mind, and commences the discipline of Karma yoga by his organs of action without attachment, is the best.

VERSE 3.8

नियतं कुरु कर्म त्वं कर्म ज्यायो ह्यकर्मणः ।
शरीरयात्रापि च ते न प्रसिद्ध्येदकर्मणः ॥ ८ ॥

niyataṁ kuru karma tvam
karma jyāyo hyakarmaṇaḥ |
śarīrayātrāpi ca te
na prasiddhyedakarmaṇaḥ ||

◆ niyatam – prescribed/obligatory; kuru – perform; ◆ karma – action; tvam – you; karma – action; jyāyaḥ – superior; hi – indeed; akarmaṇaḥ – than inaction; ◆ śarīra-yātrā – maintenance of the body; api – even; ca – and; te – your; ◆ na prasiddhyet – would not be possible; akarmaṇaḥ – through inaction.

Doing the work prescribed by the Sastras is superior to inaction. By inaction, even maintenance of the body for you would not be possible